[METRIC]
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Superseding
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November 15, 1994

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION
PAD, WRITING, LEGAL

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this commercial item description for all federal agencies.

1. **SCOPE.** This description covers legal writing pads.

2. **SALIENT CHARACTERISTICS.**

2.1 Materials. The paper shall be yellow, and made from not less than 95% bleached chemical pulp.

2.2 Physical Requirements of Paper. The paper shall conform to the physical requirements of Table I.

Table I

Characteristic	Requirement	TAPPI Test Method
Basis Weight (17X22-500) Avg. g/m^2 (lbs), +/- 5%	60 (16)	T410
Bursting strength, kpa avg., min. (psi)	83 (12)	T403
Thickness, mm +/- 0.12mm (inch, +/- 0.0005 inch)	0.076 (0.0030)	T411
Opacity, percent, min	75	T425

2.2.1 Color. The color of the sheets shall be yellow and all the sheets in a pad shall be the same color.

2.3 Backing. The pad backing shall be chipboard or other suitable paperboard which shall conform to Table II.

Table II

Characteristic	Requirement	TAPPI Test Method
Thickness, min. mm (inch)	0.48 (0.020)	T411
Bursting strength, avg. min. kpa (psi)	345 (50)	T807

Beneficial comments, recommendations, additions, deletions, clarifications, etc. and any data which may improve this document should be sent to General Services Administration, Federal Supply Service, Engineering Branch, 26 Federal Plaza, New York, NY 10278.

FSC 7530

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2.4 Size. The pads shall be 21.6 cm x 35.6 cm (8 1/2" x 14") as specified in the ordering data. A tolerance of +/- 0.3 cm (+/- 1/8") in each direction shall be permitted.

2.5 Rulings. The sheets shall be ruled on two sides as follows. Lines shall be spaced 0.8 cm (5/16") apart with a tolerance of 0.1 cm (+/-1/16"). The first line shall begin not less than 3.1 cm (1 1/4") nor more than 4.7 cm (1 7/8") from top edge of the paper. The unlined portion of the front side of the sheet shall be located at the binding end of the sheet, and the unlined portion of the back side of the sheet shall be located at the end opposite the binding end. The vertical ruling shall be located 3.1 +/- 0.3 cm (1 1/4, +/- 1/8") from the left edge of the paper and shall extend the full length of the sheet. The vertical ruling shall consist of one, two or three lines. The width between any two lines shall not exceed 0.3 cm (1/8"). The line(s) shall be located 3.1 cm +/- 0.3 cm (1 1/4, +/- 1/8") from the left edge of the paper and shall extend the full length of the sheet.

2.6 Ink. The ruling ink shall be blue, except that the vertical ruling shall be red. The ruling shall be continuous and uniform without waviness or feathering of the lines.

2.7 Assembly of pads. Each pad shall contain not less than one hundred sheets of paper and a backing sheet of equal size, +/- 0.1 cm (+/- 1/16") that is securely fastened together along the top edge (horizontal dimension). The pad shall be fastened with a hot melt plastic resin strip "material, or a cold water resistant, padding compound material or an adhesive binding materia with cheesecloth strip, at the option of the manufacturer, unless otherwise specified. Pads ruled on one side only shall be assembled with the ruled side uppermost.

2.8 Workmanship. All edges of the paper shall be smoothly and evenly cut. Paper shall be free from holes, tears, wrinkles, dirt, foreign matter, or other defects.

3. REGULATORY REQUIREMENT. The contractor shall certify that the product offered shall contain a minimum of 20% postconsumer fiber as defined by the Paper Products Recovered Materials Advisory Notice (Paper RMAN) and the Executive Order 12995 dated March 25, 1996. The Paper RMAN is found in the Federal Register, Vol 61, Part IV dated May 29, 1996. The pad backing offered shall include a minimum of 90% postconsumer recovered materials, in accordance with CFR 40 part 250. The Government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance prior to first delivery and thereafter as may be otherwise provided for under the provisions of the contract.

3.1 Bleaching. To obtain an acceptable brightness, in accordance with the performance standards of this document, a chemical bleaching process may be used. When specified in the ordering data, the bleaching process shall not include the use of chlorine, chlorine dioxide, or other chlorine compounds. The Government reserves to right to require proof of such conformance prior to first delivery and thereafter as may be otherwise provided for under the provisions of the contract.

3.2 Labeling. The recycled content shall be marked on the product or unit pack.

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4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS.

4.1 Product Conformance. The products provided shall meet the salient characteristics of this commercial item description. The quality of the product sold to the government shall be equal to or better than the quality of the product sold by the manufacturer in the commercial market. The government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance.

4.2 Testing. Testing shall be conducted in accordance with the referenced tests in the commercial Item Description. (Note: See TAPPI T400 for specific sampling instructions and acceptance criteria.)

4.3 Writing quality. The paper shall be sufficiently sized to accept fountain pen ink writing without feathering or ink penetration through to the opposite side of the sheet when tested as follows. Draw several lines and characters on both surfaces of the paper with a medium point (commercial type) fountain pen using a one percent aqueous solution of Acid Red 1 Color Index Number 18050 or Acid Green 3 Color Index Number 42085. The Acid Red 1 or the Acid Green 3 may be obtained from Pylam products, International Dyestuffs Corp., Sandoz, Incorporated and Ciba-Geigy Chemical Corp. The lines and characters shall not feather or penetrate through to the opposite side of the paper. Both surfaces of the pad paper shall be sized or otherwise processed to provide good erasability. Good erasability of the paper surface shall be determined as follows. Draw several lines and characters with a No. 2 1/2 lead pencil and erase with a latex rubber eraser; on the same area, redraw pencil lines or characters and erase. The tested area shall not show smearing of the pencil lines, or failure of the paper fiber.

5. PACKAGING, PACKING, LABELING AND MARKING. packaging, packing, labeling, and marking shall be specified in the contract or order.

6. NOTES.

6.1 Referenced Documents. The referenced documents in effect on the date of solicitation for offers or request for proposals shall be used to determine conformance with the requirements of this Commercial Item Description.

6.1.1 TAPPI test methods are available from: Technical Association of the Pulp and Paper Industry, P.O. Box 105113, Atlanta, GA 30348 (404) 209-7276.

6.1.2 The Final (Paper RMAN) is available from EPA'S public access server on the Internet or from the RCRA Hotline. The Hotline can be reached toll-free at (800) 424-9346.

Copy of Executive Order 12995 is available from:
The White House Publications Office, New Executive Office Building White House, Attn: Publications, Washington DC. 20500, telephone (202) 395-7332.

6.1.3 The Code of Federal Regulations, Title 40, Protection of Environment, Part 250 may be purchased from the Government Printing Office, Washington, D.C. 20402, phone (202) 783-3238.

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6.1.4 Copies of Commercial Item Descriptions, federal standards or specifications are available from: Federal Supply Service Bureau, Specification Section (3FPB-W), Suite 8100, 470 East L'Enfant Plaza, SW, Washington, DC 20407, phone (202) 619-8925.

6.2 Ordering Data. Purchasers should select the preferred options permitted herein, and include the following information in procurement documents:

1. Title, number and date of the Commercial Item Description

2. Size and Color

3. Non-Chlorine bleaching if specifies

4. Specific, Packaging, Packing, Marking and Palletization

7. LIST OF NSN.

7530-01-124-7632

MILITARY INTERESTS:

NONE: DoD has no registered interest in revisions and amendments to this Commercial Item Description until further notice.

Preparing Activity:

GSA-FSS

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